

# Practical response strategies when coworkers or managers take credit for your work — Action Checklist

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## VERIFY BEFORE ACTING

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- ☐ **Verify Before Acting:** Ask the three key questions honestly: What exactly was said? What exactly was yours? Was intent present? Answering these prevents acting on misinterpretation and gives you legitimate ground to stand on.
- ☐ **Verify Before Acting:** Complete the Credit Audit Worksheet in writing, separating facts from interpretations, because writing it out forces you to distinguish what actually happened from how you're currently feeling.
- ☐ **Verify Before Acting:** Identify one specific contribution nobody can dispute to anchor yourself when self-doubt starts questioning your own value and making you wonder if the theft even happened.
- ☐ **Verify Before Acting:** Wait 24 hours before responding if you're uncertain, because clarity often comes once the initial sting fades and you can think more clearly about whether the situation warrants action.

## BUILD YOUR DOCUMENTATION

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- ☐ **Build Your Documentation:** Send follow-up emails after meetings where you contributed key points to create a timestamped record that proves you were present and what you added to the conversation.
- ☐ **Build Your Documentation:** Reply-all to emails where credit is being discussed to restate your specific contribution clearly and create written documentation that will be hard to dispute later.
- ☐ **Build Your Documentation:** Keep a running log of meetings, your contributions, and decisions made in each one to build a pattern of evidence showing your involvement over time.
- ☐ **Build Your Documentation:** Document each incident with the date, context, what was said, and what you contributed so you have facts ready if you need to escalate or have a conversation later.

## RESPOND STRATEGICALLY

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- ☐ **Respond Strategically:** Prepare a calm, factual response for when it happens again so you're not caught off guard and scrambling for words in the moment when emotions are running high.
  - ☐ **Respond Strategically:** Reply to the thread where your work was claimed with a statement like 'Building on my earlier analysis...' to reassert your contribution without making accusations or creating conflict.
  - ☐ **Respond Strategically:** Have a private debrief with your manager where you calmly present the facts and request clarification rather than accusation, because this approach preserves relationships while protecting you.
  - ☐ **Respond Strategically:** Decide what outcome you want before entering any conversation about credit theft so you stay focused on your goal rather than getting sidetracked by defensiveness or emotion.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.